



CANNONS & COASTLINES



A Tabletop Naval Conquest Game

RULES OF PLAY

v0.6

**IN DEVELOPMENT ·
SUBJECT TO CHANGE**

*Rules, factions, and fleet compositions
may shift as we playtest.*

Welcome Aboard

Cannons & Coastlines is a tabletop naval game for 2 to 20 players. Each player commands a small fleet of 3D-printed ships that roll across the table on built-in wheels. The ships fire real, tension-loaded miniature cannons and cannonballs. The game has no dice, board, or grid. Just the ships, the islands between them, and the coins earned from holding those islands.

AT THE TABLE

Players: 2–20 (2–6 Default · 6–20 Group) · **Ages:** 10+ · **Play time:** 30–90 min

HOW IT WORKS

On each turn, every one of the ships in your fleet steers or fires, never both, and then sails forward. A ship touching an island may take an island action instead and hold still. To steer, swivel the ship; to move it, push it along its wheels, which click to count the distance. To fire, plug one of your cannons into a slot on the ship and press down on the firing mechanism until the shot releases. The shot goes straight out from the slot, so you line up your aim **before** the turn you fire.

Each cannonball hit knocks one **fitting** (a removable piece off your ship, like masts or cargo) off the target ship, and the shooter keeps it as a **prize**. A ship with no fittings left is **dead in the water**: it can no longer move, but it can still fire. The bare hull can absorb **one more hit** after the last fitting is gone; the hit after that sinks the ship.

Islands sit between the fleets. Capture one by planting your flag on it and it will pay out **coins**. Coins are spent at the start of any turn for one-time effects listed in the Coin Actions section. Points come from the islands you hold and the prizes in front of you, so the fleet that wins is the one that fights for them.

Setup

1. **Build your fleet.** Claim a faction's ships, flags, cannons, and cannonballs. Place your faction card in front of you. (Bonus: Design your own paper flags!)
2. **Choose a table.** A **6 ft round** or a **6 or 8 ft folding table** works well.
3. **Place the islands.** Going clockwise, each player sets one island on the table. Keep islands at least **6" apart** and **12" from any table edge**. On a narrow folding table, run them down the middle, as far from the long edges as it allows; if the count below does not fit, place as many as do.
4. **Add terrain (optional).** Together, place 2–6 rocks or reefs anywhere on the table. Terrain blocks ships and breaks up firing lanes. You can use household objects for this.
5. **Deploy your fleet.** Claim a stretch of table edge and line your ships up **touching it**, facing inward, fleets spread evenly around the table. With **two players**, sit a **quarter of the way round** a round table from each other, or **diagonally** across a folding table (opposite long sides, opposite halves). With three or more, set a rock just past each end of every fleet's line, a few inches in from the edge. (Islanders: use *Home Waters* now to place your starting ship at an island.)
6. **Fill the bag.** Put all coins into the draw bag and shake it to mix.
7. **Begin play.** The youngest player goes first. Play passes clockwise. Choose Default mode (2–6 players) or Group mode (6–20 players).

PLAYERS	ISLANDS
2	4
3–4	6
5–6	8
Group mode (6–20)	10–12

Your Turn

Each of your ships takes its turn, one at a time. Before any ship starts its turn, you may **spend coins**. Play then passes to the next player.

SPENDING COINS

Coins are not actions. Spend them **before a ship starts its turn**: at the start of your turn, or between one ship's turn and the next, never partway through a ship's turn. You may spend any number of coins on a single turn. After a coin's effect resolves, return it to the bag.

There is **no hand limit**. You may hold as many coins as you collect.

EACH SHIP

Ships are forever sailing forward. On its turn, each of your ships does two things, in this order:

1. **One action**: Set Heading, Fire, or an Island action.
2. **Click forward** at least once, up to its faction's **Move Count**.

A ship that takes an Island action while touching the island skips the forward click. No ship both steers and fires on the same turn.

Passing a turn. A  **Signal Flags** coin passes one ship's action to another.

The first only clicks forward; the second takes two full turns, so it may steer on one and fire on the other. The giving ship must be yours and not dead in the water; the receiving ship may be yours or an ally's. One ship may receive more than one transfer, but **Skilled Gunner** still applies to a single turn.

MOVEMENT

One click is one revolution of the ship's movement wheel (see **The Wheel**). Every ship ends its turn by clicking forward along its current heading. You cannot change heading between clicks.

MOVE COUNT		CLICKS PER TURN
2	3	1–2
3	4	1–3
4	5	1–4

Ships cannot pass through other ships, islands, rocks, or reefs. If a ship contacts any of these during a click, it stops there and forfeits any remaining clicks this turn.

Table edges. A ship that has no room to complete its mandatory click stops at the edge and forfeits any remaining clicks. If it would be forced off the table with no room at all, it is **scuttled** and removed. Plan your headings ahead.

ACTION A: SET HEADING

Rotate the ship up to **90°**, port or starboard. It adds **no** movement.

Queen's Fleet, Disciplined Crew. Queen's Fleet ships can swing a full **180°** instead of 90°, once per ship per turn.

ACTION B: FIRE

1. Take one of your cannons.
2. Plug it into any open slot on the firing ship (or, for **Fire from Island** below, on the island your ship is touching).
3. Load a cannonball, then press down on the firing mechanism until the shot fires.
4. Remove the cannon from the slot.

Cannons fire **straight out from the slot**. A ship that fires **does not Set Heading** this turn, so your aim is whatever direction the ship is already pointing. Line up the angle on an earlier turn, then commit to the shot. The shot resolves before the ship clicks forward. The same cannon can be used by more than one ship in a single turn; simply move it from one ship to the next.

Cannons need a crew. Your ship is the crew. To fire any cannon, on a ship or an island, one of your ships must be touching it and spend a Fire action. Held islands cannot fire on their own without a ship in contact.

ACTION C: ISLAND

Instead of steering or firing, a ship may take one island action:

- **Raise Flag.** Your ship is touching an empty island (or one just cleared of defenders), and was touching it **at the end of your previous turn**. Plant your flag.
- **Fire from Island.** Your ship is touching an island flying your flag. Plug a cannon into one of the island's slots and fire as normal.
- **Collect.** Your ship is **your nearest ship** to an island flying your flag, touching it or not. Draw 1 coin from the bag. Each island pays once per turn. A ship out at sea still clicks forward.

ISLANDS

Each island flies **one flag at a time**.

- **Multiple fleets touching an empty island.** No one may raise a flag until only one fleet's ships remain in contact.
- **Enemy flag on the island.** Drive off all enemy ships first, then capture as normal.
- **Your island, your ships (or a teammate's).** No conflict; the flag stays.
- **Dead-in-the-water ships do not defend.** A dead ship at your island does not block enemy capture. But if an enemy captures and repairs the dead ship, it **does** count as a defender afterward.

Combat

When a cannonball hits an enemy ship, remove one **fitting** (masts or cargo). The player who fired **keeps it** as a **prize**, and a player who sinks or captures a ship keeps its hull. Prizes score (see **Scoring**). Whenever a fitting or hull goes back onto a ship, take it from whoever holds it. No friendly fire.

- **Ship has no fittings left.** It is **Dead in the Water**. It cannot move or take island actions, but it can still fire its own guns. The bare hull can still take **one more hit** before sinking.
- **Hit on a dead-in-the-water ship.** The ship sinks.
- **Ricochets.** Only the first ship the cannonball touches takes the hit. If it is friendly, the shot is spent. Retrieve missed cannonballs at the end of your turn.

Total hits to sink = Fittings + 1. A ship with 3 fittings absorbs 3 hits to remove its fittings (leaving it dead in the water), then sinks on the 4th.

BOARDING

While your ship is **touching** an active enemy ship, you may spend



Boarding Party to remove 1 fitting from that enemy ship.

CAPTURING A DEAD ENEMY SHIP

While your ship is touching a dead-in-the-water enemy ship, spend **both**



Boarding Party and  **Repair Crew** on the same turn. Restore 1 **fitting** under your own flag. The captured ship joins your fleet, acts from your next turn, and counts as a prize hull while it sails for you.

SCUTTling

A dead-in-the-water ship sinks on the next hit it takes. You may scuttle one of your **own** dead ships to prevent an enemy from capturing it. Nobody takes a scuttled hull as a prize.

REPAIRING

Spend  **Repair Crew** to restore 1 fitting to one of your ships.

- If the ship **still has fittings**, the repair can be made from any distance.
- If the ship is **dead in the water**, another of your ships must touch it to repair.

Coin Actions

COIN	WHAT IT DOES
	Brace for Impact Place it in a ship's coin slot. It negates that ship's next hit, then returns to the bag.
	Signal Flags One of your ships gives up its action; another ship takes two full turns instead of one.
	Full Sail One of your ships steers and sails twice : Set Heading and click forward, then again. It does not fire or take an island action this turn.
	Evasive Maneuvers One of your ships slides one ship-width sideways without rotating, on top of its turn.
	Skilled Gunner One of your ships fires twice this turn, both before it clicks forward.
	Repair Crew Restore 1 fitting to one of your ships. Needed to capture.
	Boarding Party While touching an enemy ship, remove 1 fitting from it. Needed to capture.

Each player contributes 20 coins to the bag at setup: 4 Brace · 2 Signal · 2 Full Sail · 2 Evasive · 4 Gunner · 4 Repair · 2 Boarding.

Winning

The game ends in one of three ways:

- **Last fleet afloat.** Only one player still has ships on the table. That player wins.
- **Declared victory.** At the start of your turn, declare victory if you believe you have **12 or more points**. Tally all players' scores. If yours is still at least 12 and is higher than or tied with the next-highest, you win.
- **Stalemate.** Every island is under a flag and no island changed hands during the previous two rounds. Proceed to scoring. (optional)

SCORING

WHAT YOU HAVE	POINTS
Each island you hold	2
Each prize fitting	1
Each prize hull	2
<i>Bonus: most ships</i>	+2
<i>Bonus: most islands</i>	+2

Ships and coins don't score (except Treasure Fleet coins). Ties on bonuses: every tied player receives the full +2. Highest total wins. In Fleet play, score the fleet as a single player.

Example. A player holding 3 islands with 3 prize fittings (earning the most-islands bonus, and tied for most ships) scores $6 + 3 + 2 + 2 = 13$. An opponent holding 2 islands with 2 prize fittings and 1 prize hull (also tied for most ships) scores $4 + 2 + 2 + 2 = 10$. The first player declares and wins.

Alternate Modes

Three optional modes layer on top of the standard 2–6 player game: **Group Mode** for parties, **Fleets & Alliances** for cooperative or shifting-loyalty play, and **Custom Armada** for large mixed-faction battles.

GROUP MODE (6–20 PLAYERS)

All players act simultaneously. Play alternates between two phases, each on a **60–90 second timer**:

- **Movement phase.** Spend **Evasive Maneuvers**, then every ship away from an island sets heading or holds it, and clicks forward.
- **Action phase.** Spend action coins (**Brace, Gunner, Repair, Boarding, Signal Flags**), then every ship that held its heading may Fire, and every ship at an island may take an Island action. A **Signal Flags** transfer passes one ship's Fire to another, even if that ship set heading.

Choose one player as the **moderator**. They announce phases, run the timer, and resolve disputes. Group mode is intentionally more chaotic than the standard game.

FLEETS & ALLIANCES

Fleets (team play). Two or more players share a single fleet. Each commands one ship and resolves their action simultaneously on the fleet's turn. Coins and the faction passive belong to the fleet, so agree on spends together. Turn order alternates by fleet. Example: six players, two three-player Queen's Fleet sides.

Alliances. For free-for-all games. Players form or break informal pacts at any time, updating flag colors when allegiances shift.

Trading. Any two players may **freely trade coins, ships, and islands** at any time, regardless of alliance. Trades can grease a new pact, buy a turn of safety, or just keep things moving.

Watch for at the table.

- **Crippled-ship leverage.** Near-sunk players trade alliances for **Repair** coins or covering fire, sometimes flipping the game in a turn.
- **Bluffed shots.** Aim is visible a turn early; line up a shot you never fire and watch opponents divert.

- **Sacrificial hulls.** A dead-in-the-water ship still fires and blocks. Park a damaged ship in a chokepoint and it becomes a battle arena. Opponents pile in to capture or scuttle.

CUSTOM ARMADA

Contributed by Joshua David

A large-scale variant for advanced games. Each player fields a mixed armada of up to **15 ships** drawn from any factions, trading coordination for sheer presence.

Build your armada.

- Up to **15 ships** per player. No more than half may belong to a single faction.
- Use only the **printed values** (movement, cannon slots, fittings). All faction abilities are ignored.
- Recommended size by table: 4×4 ft → 4–6 ships, 5×5 ft → 6–9, 6×6 ft → 8–12, 6×8 ft or larger → 10–15.

Coin cap. An armada may hold at most **20 coins**. Any earned beyond that go straight back to the bag.

Restricted actions. Coordinating a large mixed fleet is hard:

- Only **3 ships** may **Set Heading** each turn. The rest hold their heading.
- Every ship still clicks forward. Any number of ships may **Fire** or take **Island actions**.

Squadrons (optional). Divide the armada into 2–3 Squadrons of 3–6 ships each. Each Squadron picks a **Squadron Flagship**; the whole armada also picks a single **Fleet Flagship**. Fleet Flagship effects apply armada-wide. Squadron Flagship effects apply only within their Squadron.

Command Shock. If a Flagship is sunk, the affected force loses control.

- **Fleet Flagship sunk.** The entire armada suffers shock. Remove your flags from every island you hold (they become neutral). Move every ship currently touching an island within **6"** of your table edge, facing inward. Take no actions and spend no coins for one full turn; your ships only click forward. Then designate a new Fleet Flagship and resume.
- **Squadron Flagship sunk.** Only that Squadron suffers shock, with the same effects limited to its ships and islands. Designate a new Squadron Flagship after.

Scoring. Standard scoring applies. An armada wins on islands and prizes.

The Seven Factions

Queen's Fleet and **Corsairs** come in the base game. The other five are expansion packs. The **Faction Reference Cards** have the full stats; these are just quick sketches of how each one plays.

QUEEN'S FLEET

A good pick for a first game.

Disciplined Crew: swings **180°** instead of **90°**, so maneuvering mistakes are easy to walk back.

CORSAIRS

Faster and more numerous than the Queen's Fleet, with thinner hulls.

Plunder: an **extra coin** on every successful board or capture, so their economy rewards picking fights.

TREASURE FLEET

Only two ships on the table, but every island they hold pays double.

Bountiful Harvest: **2 coins** per collect instead of 1, and unspent coins score **1 point** each, so even a small holding adds up.

STONE FLEET

Slow to cross the table, but punishing to chip at.

Stone Hulls: ignores the **first hit** each turn while at sea. One big salvo works; pecking at them doesn't. Anchored at an island, they're just stone.

SHADOW FLEET

Average across every stat, with one trick that changes the math.

Return from the Deep: sunken ships come back on a coin spend, so trading hulls isn't as final as it looks.

THE INDUSTRY

Two cannon slots per ship: a **forward-facing** bow gun and a rotating turret that can fire any direction.

Rotating Turret: the second slot sits in a **turret fitting** that swivels. Like any fitting, the turret can be shot off; if that happens, only the bow slot remains until it's repaired.

THE ISLANDERS

Fast, numerous, and each one folds to a **single hit**. Played well, the numbers make up for the paper hulls.

Home Waters: a free starting island.

The Parts

Every printed piece in the base set, with what it does and recommended print color. Faction ships and fittings vary in shape; flag or alliance color always wins if you'd rather match.

IMAGE	PIECE	COLOR
	Ship. The hull, with a wheel built into the stern and cannon slots along the deck. Each faction has its own ship model.	Faction or alliance color. Queen's Fleet ships shown in blue-grey ; Corsairs in black .
	Mast. A removable fitting that plugs into the deck, with the flag holder built into the top: slide a paper flag of any design into the slot. Print horizontally.	Wood/Brown or Black
	Short Mast. The same mast, shorter. Used on islands and on Islander catamarans.	Same as your masts
	Cargo & Barrel. Removable fittings : a chest of supplies, or a barrel. Either one fills a cargo slot.	Wood/Brown. Any natural wood tone reads correctly.
	Sail. Slides over the mast. Cosmetic, decorate and modify as you desire.	White, black, or custom
	Damaged Sail. Torn sail variant.	White, black, or custom

IMAGE	PIECE	COLOR
	Cannon. The tension-loaded firing mechanism. Plugs into cannon slots.	Black, gunmetal grey, or custom
	Cannonball. Loaded into the cannon and fired across the table. EASY TO LOSE	A bright color like neon green or orange for easy recovery. TPU optional for less bounce.
	Movement Wheel. Insert into the slot in the bottom of the hull. One full revolution is one click of movement.	Any color. Wrap a thin rubber band around the rim before assembly.
	Island. A freestanding island with cannon slots and a hole for a short mast to fly your flag. Needs nothing under it.	Green, sand, or grey; Terrain colors.
	Island Topper. A small puck with cannon slots and flag holes. Turns any household object into an island.	Sand, grey, or green; Terrain colors.
	Coins (×6 types). Drawn from the bag and spent before a ship's turn for one-time effects.	Gold

The Print List

A **faction set** is one complete print run for one player: their fleet plus a fair share of shared terrain and coins. The only non-printed parts are the draw bag (any small cloth pouch) and the wheel rubber bands. Print at **0.2 or 0.16mm** layer height, **15%** infill. Print the **fit test** first to check that masts, cargo and cannons seat.

PER FACTION SET

PIECE	QUANTITY	NOTES
Ships	2–5	Some ship models may print better with supports enabled.
Masts	1 per ship + 1 per island	Short Masts go on islands and Islander ships. Print spares.
Cargo and barrels	Varies by ship	Enough to fill your ships' fitting slots.
Sails	1 per mast	Decorate to customize your fleet.
Cannons	3–4	One works, but spares help when one wears out.
Cannonballs	10	TPU with three walls and no infill bounces less.
Movement wheel	1 per ship	Rubber band over the rim. Hard to remove once in.
Islands	2–3	Print Islands , or put Island Toppers on household objects.
Rocks / Reefs	2–4	Optional terrain. Block movement and cannonballs.
Coins	1 set of 20	Each set is 4 Brace, 2 Signal, 2 Full Sail, 2 Evasive, 4 Gunner, 4 Repair, 2 Boarding.

Designer Notes

CANNON CALIBRATION

The cannons fire by flexing printed plastic under tension, so two copies of the same cannon will rarely shoot with exactly the same force. The firing arm also softens slightly with use. **Fire a few practice rounds at the start of each game** so everyone can calibrate their aim before the first real shot counts.

THE WHEEL

Every ship has a wheel built into the stern. Two details matter:

- Wrap a thin rubber band around the rim before seating the wheel in the hull. The wheel needs the band to click at all; without it, the rim slides on the table instead of rolling.
- The wheel has a **flat spot** on one side. One full revolution brings the flat back to the table, ending one **click** and parking the ship between turns.

PRINT TIPS

- Print everything in **PLA** or **PETG** unless noted. It's rigid enough for the cannon mechanism and cheap enough to replace when pieces wear out.
- Cannonballs can be printed in **TPU**. They weigh about the same but bounce far less, which keeps shots closer to where they land. Coarser layer heights make them shoot harder and less predictably.
- The cannon's flex arm is the part to orient carefully. Lay it so the print layers run **across** the bending direction, not along it. Layer lines parallel to the flex will split under load.
- Print a few spare cannons per player. The snap mechanism loses tension after hundreds of shots. Swapping in a fresh cannon restores the original feel without reprinting the whole fleet.
- Bed leveling is critical. A nozzle too close to the bed may cause pieces like masts not to fit in their slots.

Quick Reference

EACH SHIP: ONE ACTION, THEN CLICK FORWARD

- **A, Set Heading:** Rotate up to 90°. Adds no movement.
- **B, Fire:** Plug cannon into a slot. Press to fire. No rotating.
- **C, Island:** Raise flag · Fire from island · Collect (nearest ship, 1 coin).
- **Then click forward** 1 to Move Count, unless touching an island.

Spend coins before any ship's turn.

CANNON FIRING

1. Pick a ship and a cannon slot (on the ship, or on the island it's touching).
2. Plug the cannon in.
3. Ship cannot Set Heading; aim was set on an earlier turn.
4. Press the mechanism. Fire, then click the ship forward.

Cannons need a crew. Your ship is the crew.

VICTORY POINTS

2 per island held · 1 per prize fitting · 2 per prize hull · +2 most ships · +2 most islands.

Declare Victory at start of turn with ≥ 12 points.

HIT RESOLUTION

WHAT HAPPENED	RESULT
Hits enemy ship	Pull 1 fitting, keep it as a prize
No fittings left	Dead in the water. Own guns only, 1 hit left
Dead ship hit again	Sunk. Shooter keeps the hull
Friendly, terrain, or a ricochet	Nothing. Only the first contact counts.

CAPTURING THINGS

TARGET	HOW
Dead enemy ship	Touch it + spend  Boarding &  Repair (same turn). Joins fleet at 1 fitting.
Uncaptured island	Touch it, wait a turn, then Raise Flag.
Undefended enemy island	Touch, wait a turn, swap flag.
Defended enemy island	Clear defenders, then capture as above.

COIN CHEATSHEET

-  **Brace:** shield next hit.
-  **Signal:** one ship idles, another acts twice.
-  **Full Sail:** steer and sail twice, no firing.
-  **Evasive:** slide one ship-width.
-  **Gunner:** fire twice.
-  **Repair:** restore 1 fitting.
-  **Boarding:** 1 hit at contact.



Fair winds and a following sea.

Set Sail Online



Drop anchor at **<https://cannonsandcoastlines.com>** (or scan the QR code above) to:

- **Order printed sets.** Boxed games shipped to your door, plus loose components and starter packs.
- **Download the latest rulebook & faction cards.** This is a **preview release**, so rules and cards are still in active revision. The site always carries the current version.
- **Grab the print files.** STLs for every ship, coin, and terrain piece, free for personal printing under the license below.

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